Martin and Luna in Mumbai

The Folded Map



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Martin Travels the World • Book One

Curious World Books

Grade 2

Martin and Luna in Mumbai: The Folded Map

First edition

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English edition: 32 pages, 8.5 × 8.5 in.

Reading age: 7–8 • Grade 2



Martin gripped his red backpack. He looked at the busy street. Mumbai was a rush of sounds. Many new smells filled the air. A bright pink flower lay on the ground. Martin reached to pick it up.



Luna pointed to a large map. “Look, Martin,” she said. “The festival is this way.” Her crescent-moon charm jingled softly. She smiled at him.



Martin pulled out his small notebook. He wanted to draw everything. A woman in a colorful sari smiled. Many people walked by. They carried baskets.



They walked past tall buildings. Many people carried big baskets. Music played from an open doorway. Martin tapped his foot to the beat. It was a lively tune. Bells chimed softly.



Suddenly, a boy stumbled. His basket of flowers tipped. Pink and yellow petals scattered. They landed on the dusty ground. He looked very sad. His shoulders slumped.



Martin rushed forward. “I can help!” he exclaimed. He started picking up flowers quickly. He gathered them into a messy pile. He felt proud of his speed.



The boy shook his head. He looked down at the ground. His eyes were wide with worry. He did not speak. He looked at the crushed petals. His mouth was a tight line.



Luna knelt beside the boy. She spoke softly. “Are these for a special reason?” she asked. She pointed to the crushed petals. Her voice was gentle.



The boy nodded slowly. He carefully picked up a single perfect pink flower. He held it gently. He looked towards a small temple. It had a tall, carved spire.

Martin stopped. He saw the boy’s careful hands. His own pile of flowers looked less special. Many were broken. He felt a little confused. He frowned slightly.



Together they placed every flower back in the basket, one by one, with gentle hands. The basket looked more beautiful than ever.

Luna asked, “Are these flowers part of the festival?” The boy’s face brightened. He nodded with a big smile and pointed to his basket.



He explained, “They are offerings.” “For good luck and thanks.” He showed them a small, folded map.

Martin looked at his messy pile. He saw how many were broken. His quick help was not truly helpful. He felt a pang of sadness. He wished he had waited.

Luna said, “We can help find more.” She looked at the boy. “Where can we find the best ones?”

The boy pointed down a narrow alley. “My grandmother sells them.” “Fresh ones.” He looked much happier now.

Martin and Luna followed him. They found a small stall. The grandmother sorted beautiful flowers. Martin helped carry a new basket.


Listen first.

At the temple, the boy arranged his fresh flowers. He placed them carefully. Martin watched him with new eyes. He felt warm inside. He finally understood. He felt gratitude.

Martin drew the boy, the flowers, and Luna in his notebook. He wrote, “Listen first.” It was a good lesson. He added a small temple drawing.

Luna smiled at Martin. “You listened well,” she said. Martin nodded. He felt grateful for her help. He closed his notebook. He felt calm and happy.

“Listen first.”

Martin learned that true help is gentle.
Compassion means slowing down, watching with care,
and helping with gentle hands.

New words

offerings – gifts given to show thanks

gratitude – a warm feeling of thankfulness

sari – a long cloth dress worn in India

spire – the tall pointed top of a temple

festival – a special day of celebration

About the series

The ‘Martin Travels the World’ series follows Martin, a curious boy who learns to listen before acting, and Luna, whose keen eyes and calm courage guide every adventure. Each book visits a new place on the map — and a new way to care.

About this book

Martin and Luna are in bustling Mumbai! When a boy’s flowers spill, Martin wants to fix it fast. But Luna notices something important. Will Martin learn that listening first can change everything?

A heartwarming story about compassion and gratitude, set on the vibrant streets of India.


Join Martin and Luna
on their next adventure!

Quick Guide for Parents and Teachers

Martin and Luna in Mumbai - The Folded Map - Value: Listen first

Before reading

Look at the cover with your child. What do Martin and Luna see? Ask for a prediction: What do you think will happen?

During reading

Pause when the basket falls. What might the boy need? Compare Martin's hurry with Luna's questions. Accept spoken, written, or drawn answers.

After reading

Choose one or two activities. Go back to the story if there are doubts. It is not a race or a test.

What to notice

Connect words and pictures using clues. - Explain the order of at least four events. - Point out where Martin listens before acting.

Weekly routine

Monday: read - Tuesday: listen to the audio - Wednesday: play with the chunks - Thursday: draw - Friday: tell the story to someone.

Start in the most familiar language. Switch languages in the same scene and compare.

The story and its value are unchanged from the published book.

The 6 chunks with Luna

Listen to the audio, repeat while playing. No rush, no correcting.

Listen first!

Escucha primero!

I can help!

Puedo ayudar!

The folded map!

El mapa doblado!

One by one!

Uno por uno!

A basket of flowers!

Una canasta de flores!

This way!

Por aqui!

Keep the adventure going online!

This book includes the interactive version with 6 activities and audio to practise English.

Open the interactive version

https://rickhazur.github.io/portafolio/samples/books/01-Mumbai-Interactive.html

Save it in your favourites to come back whenever you want. Have fun!